Nightreader: the sentences

Every sentence the page would say, for 12 places and nights, worked out from real figures on Tuesday November 10th 2026.

All wording is draft: it is yours to change. The points to settle are numbered at the end, so you can reply by number. Places are named by Lightreader's rule, reaching 60 miles where no town lies within 25; where there is still none (Shetland, Scilly), the compass point alone.

A. Reading (RG1)

Tuesday November 10th into Wednesday: tonight, just after a new Moon.

11h 2m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:17 to 05:19, 11h 2m in all. The Moon stays down throughout.

The Moon

- New Moon, 3% lit.
- It stays below the horizon all night.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 17:28 to 01:12 (in view from 16:59 to 02:20). At its highest, at 21:20, it stands 40° up (four fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Mars is well placed from 01:21 to 06:38 (in view from 00:16 to 06:38). At its highest, at 06:28, it stands 54° up (five and a half fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

- Jupiter is well placed from 01:35 to 06:48 (in view from 00:30 to 06:48). At its highest, at 06:34, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Venus is low: in view from 06:12 to 06:59, at best 16° up (one and a half fists) in the south-east, between Wokingham and Yateley, at 06:59. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Leonids: best on the night of November 17th. A fair year: 5h 56m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around November 20th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: November 24th.
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year: 8h 40m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year: the Moon is up all night.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids: best on the night of January 3rd. A good year: 11h 36m of the night is Moon-free.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.

- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

B. Reading (RG1)

Tuesday November 17th into Wednesday: a first-quarter Moon that sets before midnight.

5h 56m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:10 to 05:29, 11h 19m in all. The Moon sets at 23:33; the sky is at its darkest after that.

The Moon

- First quarter, 55% lit.
- It is already up at sunset, and sets at 23:33 in the west-south-west, roughly over Thatcham.
- At its highest during the night, at 18:24, it stands 26° up (two and a half fists) in the south, roughly over Alton.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 17:00 to 00:43 (in view from 16:50 to 01:50). At its highest, at 20:51, it stands 39° up (four fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Mars is well placed from 01:10 to 06:49 (in view from 00:05 to 06:49). At its highest, at 06:13, it stands 53° up (five and a half fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

- Jupiter is well placed from 01:11 to 06:59 (in view from 00:06 to 06:59). At its highest, at 06:09, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Venus is well placed from 07:01 to 07:10 (in view from 05:39 to 07:10). At its highest, at 07:10, it stands 21° up (two fists) in the south-east, between Crowthorne and Fleet (near Milford).
- Mercury is low: in view from 06:46 to 06:49, at best 10° up (one fist) in the east-south-east, between Wokingham and Crowthorne (near Bagshot), at 06:49. It needs a clear horizon.

Looking ahead

- Leonids: best tonight. A fair year: 5h 56m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around November 20th (Friday), when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: November 24th.
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year: 8h 40m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year: the Moon is up all night.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids: best on the night of January 3rd. A good year: 11h 36m of the night is Moon-free.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.

- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

C. Reading (RG1)

Tuesday November 24th into Wednesday: a full Moon, up all night.

No Moon-free night

The Moon is up for the whole of true night

True night runs from 18:04 to 05:38, 11h 35m in all. The Moon is up throughout.

The Moon

- Full Moon, 100% lit.
- It is up all night.
- At its highest during the night, at 00:11, it stands 65° up (six and a half fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 16:43 to 00:14 (in view from 16:43 to 01:22). At its highest, at 20:23, it stands 39° up (four fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Jupiter is well placed from 00:46 to 07:10 (in view from 23:41 to 07:10). At its highest, at 05:43, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

- Mars is well placed from 00:59 to 06:59 (in view from 23:54 to 06:59). At its highest, at 05:57, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Venus is well placed from 06:39 to 07:21 (in view from 05:18 to 07:21). At its highest, at 07:21, it stands 24° up (two and a half fists) in the south-south-east, between Yateley and Fleet (near Milford).
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

Looking ahead

- Full Moon: today (November 24th).
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year: 8h 40m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year: the Moon is up all night.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids: best on the night of January 3rd. A good year: 11h 36m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best evenings for Mercury: around February 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.

- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

D. Reading (RG1)

Wednesday December 2nd into Thursday: a Moon that rises during the night.

7h 45m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:00 to 05:48, 11h 48m in all. The Moon rises at 01:44; the sky is at its darkest before that.

The Moon

- Last quarter, 32% lit.
- It rises at 01:44 in the east, between Windsor and Wokingham (near North Ascot), and is still up at sunrise.
- At its highest during the night, at 07:27, it stands 32° up (three fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 16:38 to 23:41 (in view from 16:38 to 00:49). At its highest, at 19:51, it stands 39° up (four fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Jupiter is well placed from 00:16 to 07:21 (in view from 23:12 to 07:21). At its highest, at 05:13, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Mars is well placed from 00:43 to 07:10 (in view from 23:39 to 07:10). At its highest, at 05:38, it stands 51° up (five fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

- Venus is well placed from 06:28 to 07:32 (in view from 05:06 to 07:32). At its highest, at 07:32, it stands 26° up (two and a half fists) in the south-south-east, between Yateley and Fleet.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

Looking ahead

- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year: 8h 40m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year: the Moon is up all night.
- Full Moon: December 24th.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids: best on the night of January 3rd. A good year: 11h 36m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best evenings for Mercury: around February 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

E. Reading (RG1)

Sunday February 14th into Monday: Jupiter and Mars at their best.

2h 14m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 19:09 to 05:26, 10h 17m in all. The Moon sets at 03:12; the sky is at its darkest after that.

The Moon

- First quarter, 58% lit.
- It is already up at sunset, and sets at 03:12 in the north-west, between Didcot and Wallingford.
- At its highest during the night, at 18:19, it stands 64° up (six and a half fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

The planets

- Jupiter is well placed from 18:55 to 05:09 (in view from 17:50 to 06:13). At its highest, at 00:02, it stands 54° up (five and a half fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Saturn is well placed from 17:52 to 19:13 (in view from 17:52 to 20:20). At its highest, at 17:52, it stands 31° up (three fists) in the south-west, between Whitchurch and Tadley (near Burghfield Common).
- Mars is well placed from 19:46 to 05:53 (in view from 18:42 to 06:53). At its highest, at 00:50, it stands 53° up (five and a half fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Venus is low: in view from 06:47 to 07:03, at best 11° up (one fist) in the south-south-east, between Yateley and Fleet (near Milford), at 07:03. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Mars at its best: February 19th (Friday), when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Full Moon: February 20th (Saturday).
- New Moon: March 8th.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around March 17th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Lyrids: best on the night of April 22nd. A poor year: only 22m of the night is Moon-free.
- Eta Aquariids: best on the night of May 6th. A very good year: no Moon at all.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

F. Reading (RG1)

Monday June 21st into Tuesday: the shortest night: no true night.

No Moon-free night

The Moon is up for the whole of "very dark"

There's no true night tonight: the darkest the sky gets is "very dark", from 23:26 to 02:45, 3h 19m in all. The Moon is up throughout.

The Moon

- Waning gibbous, 92% lit.

- It rises at 23:16 in the south-east, between Wokingham and Crowthorne (near Bagshot), and is still up at sunrise.
- At its highest during the night, at 03:35, it stands 18° up (two fists) in the south, roughly over Alton.

The planets

- Jupiter is low: in view from 21:58 to 22:58, at best 19° up (two fists) in the west, roughly over Hungerford, at 21:58. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mars is well placed from 22:13 to 22:38 (in view from 22:13 to 23:44). At its highest, at 22:13, it stands 24° up (two and a half fists) in the west-south-west, between Tadley and Thatcham.
- Saturn is low: in view from 03:08 to 03:59, at best 18° up (two fists) in the east, between Windsor and Wokingham (near North Ascot), at 03:59. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, below the horizon all night.
- Venus: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- New Moon: July 4th.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around July 15th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: July 18th.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Perseids: best on the night of August 12th. A fair year: 2h 2m of the night is Moon-free.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

- Jupiter at its best: March 12th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Best evenings for Venus: around March 22nd, when it is furthest from the Sun.

G. Edinburgh (EH1)

Tuesday November 10th into Wednesday: tonight, further north.

11h 7m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:24 to 05:31, 11h 7m in all. The Moon stays down throughout.

The Moon

- New Moon, 3% lit.
- It stays below the horizon all night.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 17:53 to 01:05 (in view from 16:56 to 02:22). At its highest, at 21:29, it stands 35° up (three and a half fists) in the south, between Loanhead and Penicuik.
- Mars is well placed from 01:30 to 06:59 (in view from 00:18 to 06:59). At its highest, at 06:37, it stands 49° up (five fists) in the south, between Loanhead and Penicuik.
- Jupiter is well placed from 01:46 to 07:10 (in view from 00:34 to 07:10). At its highest, at 06:43, it stands 48° up (five fists) in the south, between Loanhead and Penicuik.
- Venus is low: in view from 06:42 to 07:22, at best 14° up (one and a half fists) in the south-east, between Dalkeith and Bonnyrigg (near Gorebridge), at 07:22. It needs a clear horizon.

- Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Leonids: best on the night of November 17th. A fair year: 6h 11m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around November 20th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: November 24th.
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year: 9h of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year: the Moon is up all night.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids: best on the night of January 3rd. A very good year: no Moon at all.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:11 to 10:52. At 10:00 the Moon covers 27% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 36° up.

H. Edinburgh (EH1)

Monday June 21st into Tuesday: the shortest night in Edinburgh: only “dark”.

42m
of Moon-free “dark”

There’s no true night tonight: the darkest the sky gets is “dark”, from 23:05 to 03:24, 4h 19m in all. The Moon rises at 23:47; the sky is at its darkest before that.

The Moon

- Waning gibbous, 92% lit.
- It rises at 23:47 in the south-east, roughly over Dalkeith, and is still up at sunrise.
- At its highest during the night, at 03:44, it stands 13° up (one and a half fists) in the south, between Loanhead and Penicuik.

The planets

- Jupiter is low: in view from 22:45 to 23:13, at best 14° up (one and a half fists) in the west, between Broxburn and Queensferry (near Kirkliston), at 22:45. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mars is low: in view from 23:06 to 23:51, at best 16° up (one and a half fists) in the west-south-west, between Livingston and Broxburn (near Ratho), at 23:06. It needs a clear horizon.
- Saturn is low: in view from 03:17 to 03:24, at best 11° up (one fist) in the east, between Prestonpans and Musselburgh, at 03:24. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, below the horizon all night.
- Venus: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- New Moon: July 4th.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around July 15th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: July 18th.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:11 to 10:52. At 10:00 the Moon covers 27% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Perseids: best on the night of August 12th. A fair year: 1h 33m of the night is Moon-free.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 36° up.
- Jupiter at its best: March 12th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Best evenings for Venus: around March 22nd, when it is furthest from the Sun.

I. Lerwick (ZE1)

Tuesday November 10th into Wednesday: tonight in Shetland: no towns in reach.

11h 12m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:13 to 05:25, 11h 12m in all. The Moon stays down throughout.

The Moon

- New Moon, 3% lit.

- It stays below the horizon all night.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 18:05 to 00:36 (in view from 16:35 to 02:06). At its highest, at 21:21, it stands 31° up (three fists) in the south.
- Mars is well placed from 01:24 to 07:05 (in view from 00:02 to 07:05). At its highest, at 06:29, it stands 45° up (four and a half fists) in the south.
- Jupiter is well placed from 01:41 to 07:18 (in view from 00:20 to 07:18). At its highest, at 06:35, it stands 44° up (four and a half fists) in the south.
- Venus is low: in view from 07:01 to 07:32, at best 13° up (one and a half fists) in the south-east, at 07:32. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Leonids: best on the night of November 17th. A fair year: 6h 28m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around November 20th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: November 24th.
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year: 9h 25m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year: the Moon is up all night.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids: best on the night of January 3rd. A very good year: no Moon at all.

- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:23 to 10:47. At 10:05 the Moon covers 15% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 34° up.

J. Sandwick (ZE2)

Monday June 21st into Tuesday: the shortest night in the north of Shetland.

No Moon-free night

The Moon is up for the whole of "dark"

There's no true night tonight: the darkest the sky gets is "dark", from 00:35 to 01:39, 1h 4m in all. The Moon is up throughout.

The Moon

- Waning gibbous, 92% lit.
- It rises at 00:09 in the south-east, and is still up at sunrise.

The planets

- Mercury: not in view tonight, below the horizon all night.
- Venus: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.
- Mars: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.
- Jupiter: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

- Saturn: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

Looking ahead

- New Moon: July 4th.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around July 15th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: July 18th.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:24 to 10:47. At 10:05 the Moon covers 15% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Perseids: best on the night of August 12th. A good year: 3h 14m of the night is Moon-free.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 34° up.
- Jupiter at its best: March 12th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Best evenings for Venus: around March 22nd, when it is furthest from the Sun.

K. Penzance (TR18)

Sunday January 3rd into Monday: Venus at its best in the morning; the Quadrantids.

11h 26m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:31 to 06:22, 11h 51m in all. The Moon rises at 05:57; the sky is at its darkest before that.

The Moon

- Waning crescent, 13% lit.
- It rises at 05:57 in the south-east, and is still up at sunrise.
- At its highest during the night, at 08:20, it stands 11° up (one fist) in the south-south-east.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 17:11 to 22:01 (in view from 17:11 to 23:06). At its highest, at 18:04, it stands 41° up (four fists) in the south.
- Jupiter is well placed from 22:24 to 07:53 (in view from 21:22 to 07:53). At its highest, at 03:23, it stands 54° up (five and a half fists) in the south.
- Mars is well placed from 23:34 to 07:42 (in view from 22:31 to 07:42). At its highest, at 04:20, it stands 51° up (five fists) in the south.
- Venus is well placed from 07:26 to 08:04 (in view from 05:44 to 08:04). At its highest, at 08:04, it stands 22° up (two fists) in the south-south-east.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, below the horizon all night.

Looking ahead

- Best mornings for Venus: around now (January 3rd), when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids: best tonight. A good year: 11h 26m of the night is Moon-free.
- New Moon: January 7th (Thursday).
- Full Moon: January 22nd.
- Best evenings for Mercury: around February 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.

- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 08:58 to 10:55. At 09:55 the Moon covers 47% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 38° up.

L. Cardiff / Caerdydd (CF10)

Thursday August 12th into Friday: the Perseids; a place with a double name.

2h 2m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 23:09 to 03:27, 4h 19m in all. The Moon sets at 01:26; the sky is at its darkest after that.

The Moon

- Waxing gibbous, 84% lit.
- It is already up at sunset, and sets at 01:26 in the south-west, roughly over Barry.
- At its highest during the night, at 21:57, it stands 11° up (one fist) in the south, between Bridgwater and Watchet.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 01:03 to 05:16 (in view from 23:58 to 05:16). At its highest, at 05:16, it stands 47° up (four and a half fists) in the south, between Burnham-on-Sea and Wiveliscombe (near Creech St Michael).

- Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.
- Venus: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.
- Mars: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.
- Jupiter: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Perseids: best tonight. A fair year: 2h 2m of the night is Moon-free.
- Full Moon: August 17th (Tuesday).
- New Moon: August 31st.
- Best evenings for Mercury: around September 24th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Orionids: best on the night of October 21st. A poor year: only 2h 14m of the night is Moon-free.
- Leonids: best on the night of November 17th. A poor year: only 43m of the night is Moon-free.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 37° up.
- Eclipse of the Sun: January 26th, from 15:35 to 17:55. At 16:48 the Moon covers 54% of the Sun. Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.
- Jupiter at its best: March 12th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Best evenings for Venus: around March 22nd, when it is furthest from the Sun.

Points for John

1. The opening figure and the words under it: “10h 59m / of Moon-free true night”, “No Moon-free night / The Moon is up for the whole of true night”, and in summer “of Moon-free “very dark””. Do the quotation marks round “very dark” and “dark” work, or would you rather a coloured tag as Lightreader has?
2. The sentence beside the Moon: “True night runs from 18:19 to 05:17, 10h 59m in all. The Moon stays down throughout.” and its variants (“sets at 23:33; the sky is at its darkest after that”).
3. A safety net: “No darkness tonight / Half-light all night”, with “The Sun stays close below the horizon, so the sky never gets dark.” Not seen in these examples: even the north of Shetland gets an hour of “dark” at midsummer.
4. The Moon’s lines: rising and setting with their directions, and “At its highest during the night, at 00:11, it stands 65° up (six and a half fists) in the south …”.
5. A well-placed planet: “Saturn is well placed from 17:31 to 01:12 (in view from 16:59 to 02:20). At its highest, at 21:20, it stands 40° up (four fists) in the south, roughly over Alton.” Is giving both spans too much?
6. A low planet: “Venus is low: in view from … to …, at best 15° up (one and a half fists) in the south-east, …. It needs a clear horizon.”
7. A planet not in view: “Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.” / “too low while the sky is dark” / “below the horizon all night”.
8. Degrees and fists together, “40° up (four fists)”: both, or fists only in the sentence with degrees left to the picture?
9. Looking ahead: the Moon’s next new and full by date only. Would you like the time of day too?
10. Eclipses: the wording, and the safety sentence on an eclipse of the Sun (“Never look at the Sun without proper eclipse glasses.”).

11. Planets at their best: “Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.” and “Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.”
12. Meteor showers: the next one always, and any other within about 100 days. The verdicts (my rule, for you to change): “a very good year” with no Moon at all, “a good year” when three-quarters or more of the night is Moon-free, “a fair year” from about a third, otherwise “a poor year”.
13. Dates follow Lightreader: no weekday, except in brackets when one to six days ahead; the year only when more than 300 days away.
14. Short spells. Some are only minutes long: on November 17th Mercury is “in view from 06:46 to 06:49” and Venus “well placed from 07:01 to 07:10” (case B). Shall a spell shorter than, say, 15 minutes not count?
15. Directions repeat: three planets can all be highest “in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook)” on the same night (case A). True, but repetitive. Keep the towns on every line, or only where the direction differs from the line before?
16. Double names such as “Cardiff / Caerdydd” come from the postcode list. Lightreader shows one name; shall Nightreader show the English name only?